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Course:

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Department:

Computer Science

Section

BCS-4(B)

PROJECT REPORT

Title:

Is AI our greatest ally or a silent threat in disguise?

(AI: Friend or Foe?)

ABSTRACT:

This report examines public perspectives on Artificial Intelligence (AI), focusing on whether it is viewed as a valuable companion or a potential danger. Drawing on responses to an 18-question survey distributed across diverse professions and backgrounds, the study examines attitudes toward AI in five key areas: daily life, employment, privacy, education, and regulation. Visual aids are used to help interpret the data and highlight prevailing sentiments.

Results showed that most respondents believe AI provides more opportunities and is a helpful friend, though concerns about privacy and job loss remain. The findings reveal a blend of appreciation and concern, highlighting both the promise and the peril of AI in our world today. While a majority of respondents acknowledge AI's usefulness in everyday tasks and convenience, significant concerns were raised around job displacement, emotional detachment, and overreliance. Privacy emerged as a key issue, with many participants hesitant to entrust sensitive information to AI systems. Overall, the results suggest a cautiously curious public—intrigued by AI's potential, yet wary of its risks. This duality reflects the central tension explored in this report: is AI our greatest ally or a silent threat in disguise?

INTRODUCTION:

Artificial Intelligence (AI) has rapidly become an inseparable part of modern life. From voice assistants and automated services to complex decision-making systems, AI is transforming industries, education, communication, and even human emotions. Its presence is felt in nearly every aspect of our daily lives, shaping the way we live and work.

While the advantages of AI, i.e. efficiency, convenience, and innovation are undeniable, it also raises serious concerns. Can it be trusted? Will it replace human jobs? Is it evolving too quickly to be properly controlled? Ethical dilemmas, job displacement, and the risk of overdependence are at the heart of public debate.

Despite these growing concerns about job loss, privacy, and ethical issues, many experts believe that Artificial Intelligence is more of a helpful ally than a threat. As Sundar Pichai, CEO of Google, stated, "AI is one of the most important things humanity is working on. It is more profound than

fire or electricity.” This highlights AI's potential to positively transform human life. Similarly, Satya Nadella, CEO of Microsoft, believes that “AI is going to be the next big shift in technology that empowers people to do more,” showing that AI can support and enhance human abilities. While it's important to be cautious, these views suggest that with proper use and regulation, AI can be a powerful friend to society.

This report presents the findings of a survey conducted to explore public opinion on AI. It aims to determine whether people view AI as a powerful ally that enhances human potential or as a silent threat with potentially dangerous consequences. By analyzing responses from individuals of different backgrounds and presenting the results through pie chart analysis, the report seeks to understand the current perception of AI in society.

OBJECTIVES OF THE STUDY:

- To assess the usage frequency of AI technologies among students and professionals.
- To identify the perceived benefits of Artificial Intelligence, particularly in terms of saving time and effort in daily activities.
- To explore the major concerns related to AI, with special focus on data privacy, trust in AI decision-making, and ethical implications.
- To examine public opinion on the degree of human control over AI systems and the comfort level regarding AI making decisions independently.
- To explore how people view AI's effect on jobs, especially concerns about losing employment or being replaced by machines.
- To analyze attitudes toward AI's influence on creativity, problem-solving abilities, and potential misuse (e.g., cheating with AI tools).
- To understand who the public believes should be responsible for regulating AI use safely (government, tech companies, and users).
- To determine the extent to which people feel AI is increasingly taking over decision-making roles traditionally held by humans.
- To explore concerns about AI surpassing human intelligence and the implications of such developments.
- To evaluate the overall sentiment towards AI—whether it is seen as a helpful friend that empowers individuals or as a potential threat.

METHODOLOGY

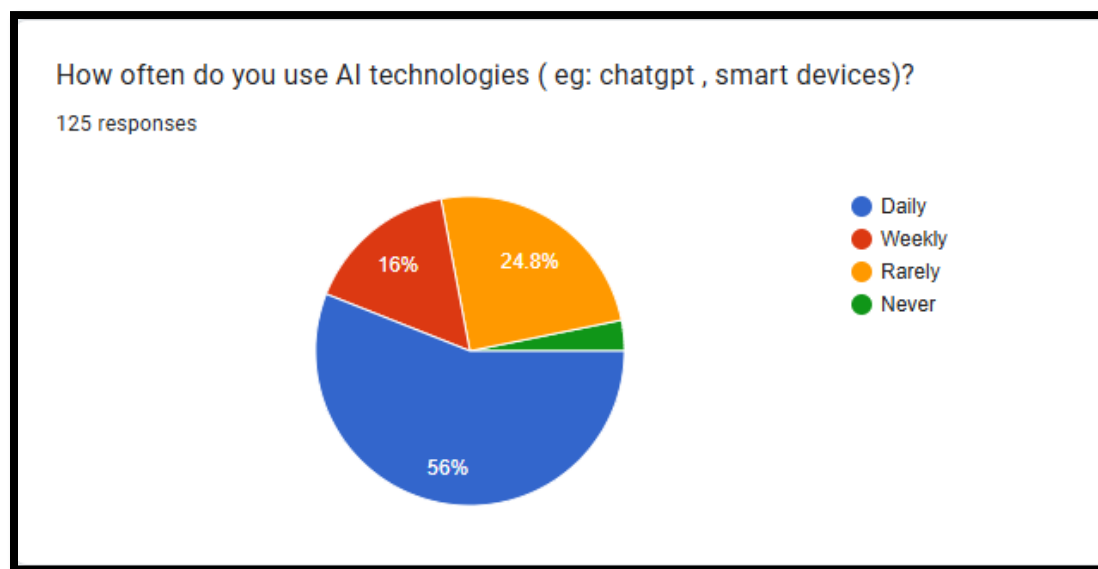
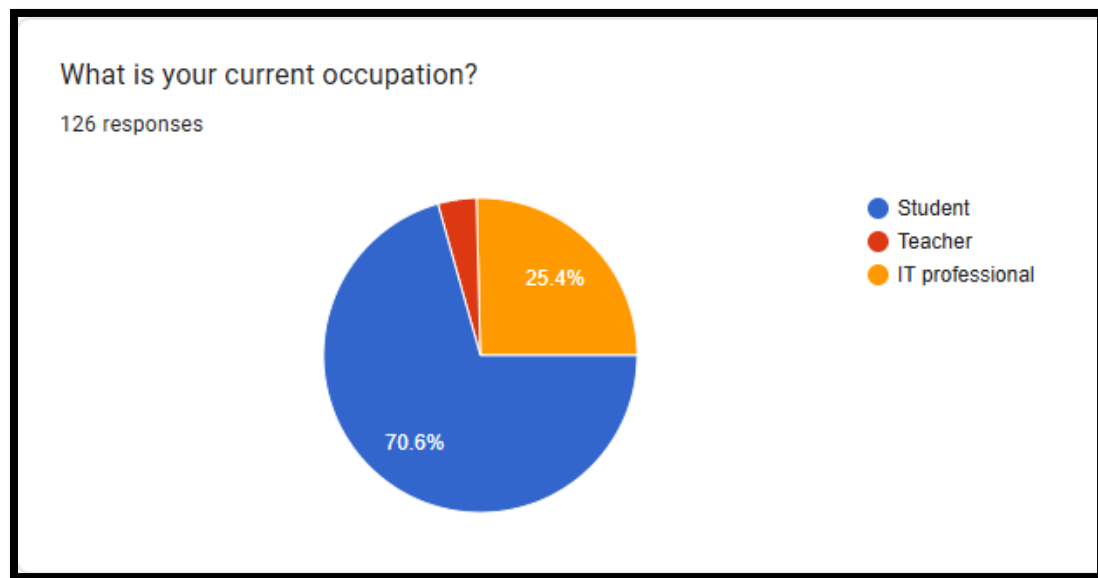
The data for this report was collected using a structured online questionnaire containing 18 questions. The survey was distributed digitally, and participants submitted their responses

voluntarily. The data was compiled and presented through pie charts to visually interpret the trends and opinions.

SAMPLE

The survey received responses from 126 individuals. Participants included students, Teachers and IT professionals.

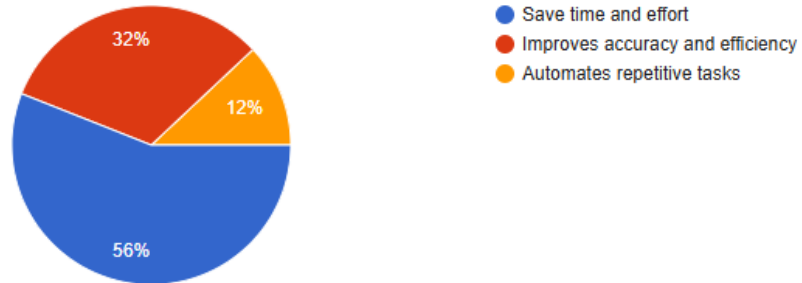
ANALYSIS THROUGH PIE CHART



Which of the following do you consider a benefit of AI?



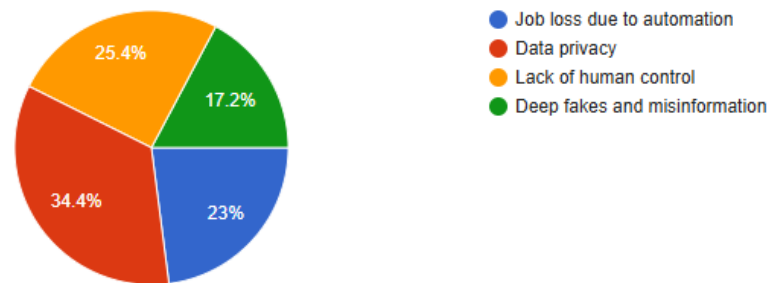
125 responses



Which of these are your biggest concerns of AI?

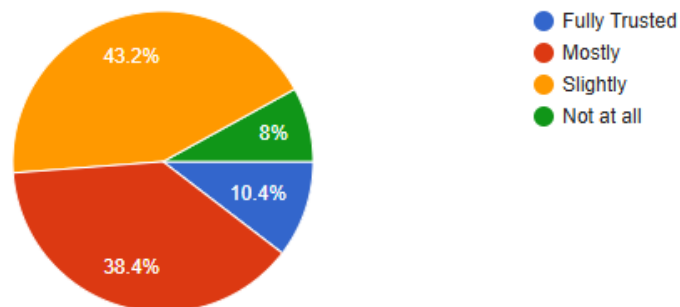


122 responses



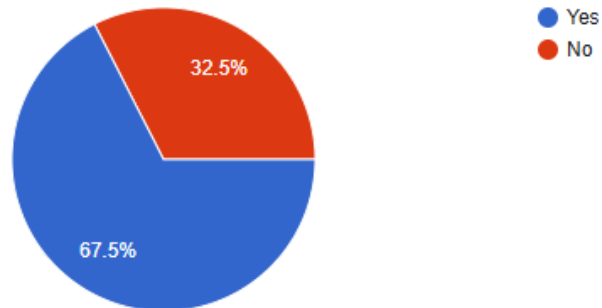
How much do you trust AI systems in sensitive decisions(eg: hiring , grading , medical diagnosis) ?

125 responses



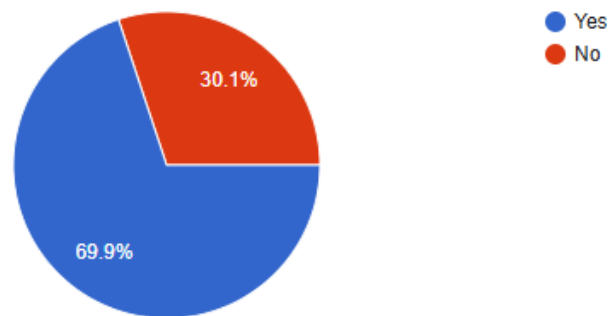
Would you feel uncomfortable if AI systems made decisions without human control?

123 responses



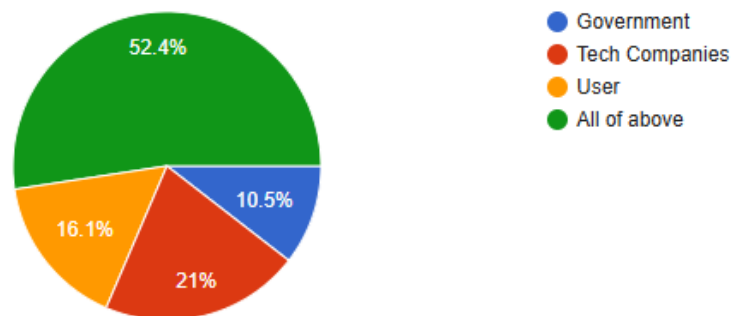
Are you concerned that AI collects too much personal data?

123 responses



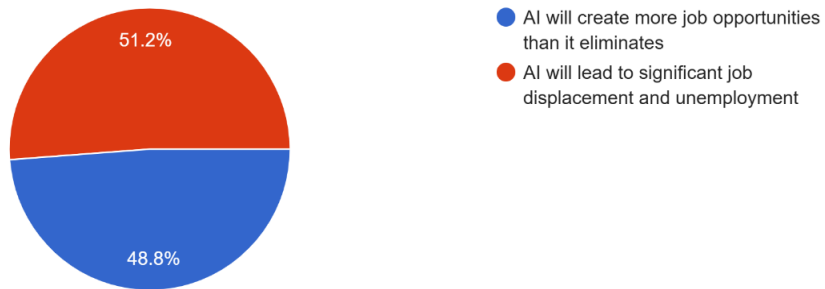
Who should be responsible for making sure AI is used safely?

124 responses



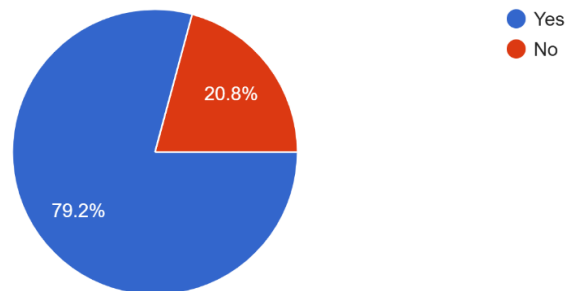
Which statement comes closer to your opinion on AI's role in future of your work?

125 responses



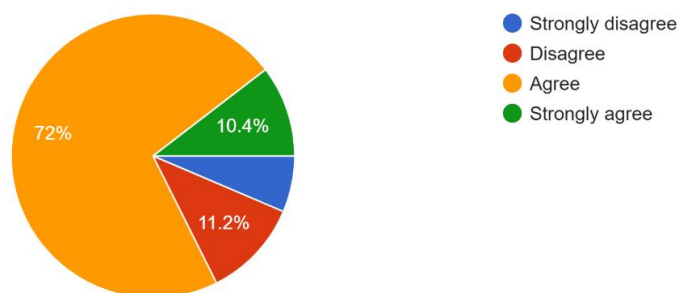
Are you worried that AI can be use to track or monitor people without their consent?

125 responses



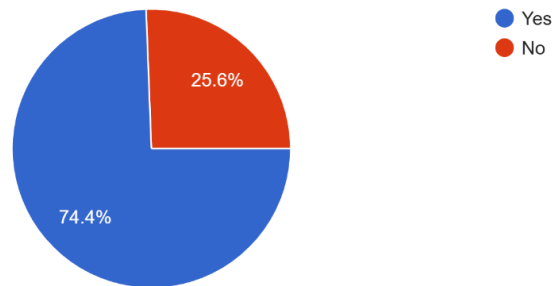
Is AI slowly taking over human decisions making?

125 responses



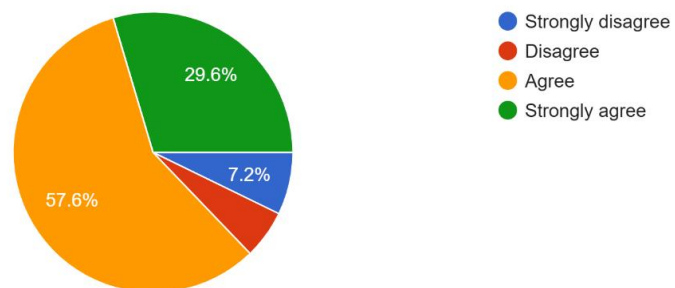
Do you think AI can also become more powerful than humans in future?

125 responses



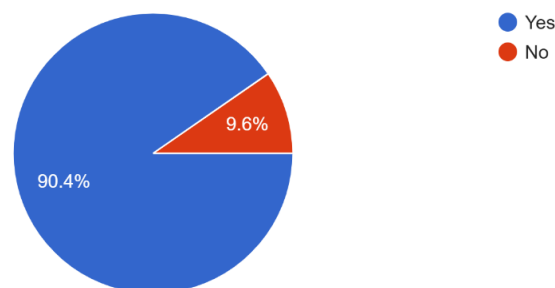
Is AI making people lazy in thinking and problem solving?

125 responses



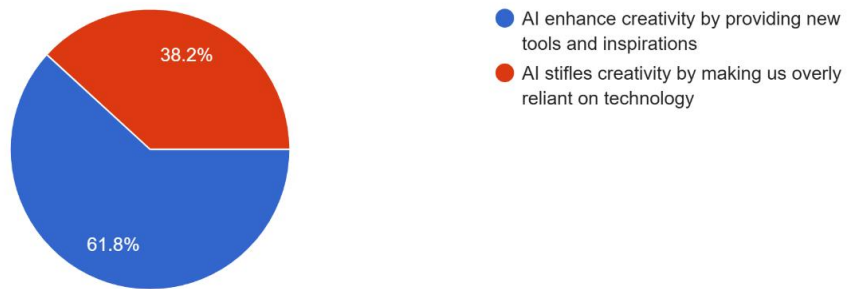
Do you think students may misuse AI tools for cheating and avoiding learning?

125 responses



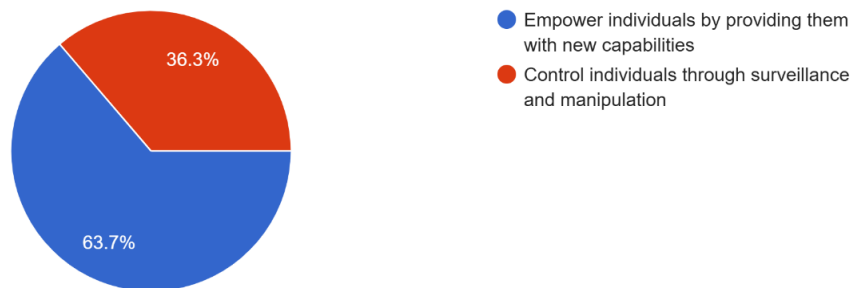
How do you perceive AI's influences on human activity?

123 responses



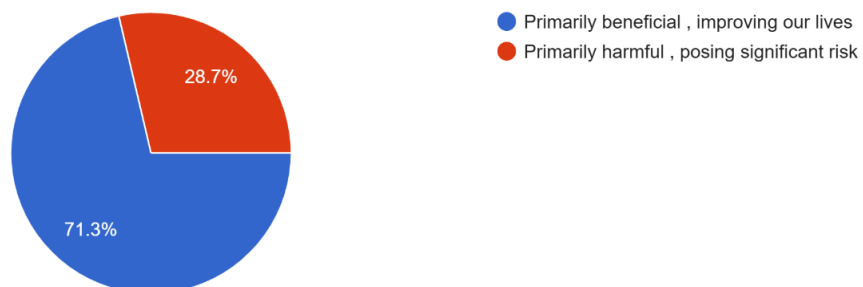
In your opinion, is AI more likely to empower individuals or control them?

124 responses



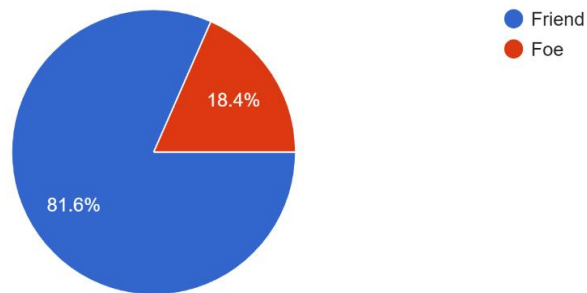
Which of the following best reflects your view of AI's impact on society?

122 responses



How would you describe your overall feelings toward AI?

125 responses



SUMMARY OF THE DATA

- Most participants use AI technologies like ChatGPT and smart devices **daily**.
- The top benefit of AI, as reported, is that it **saves time and effort**.
- The biggest concern expressed was **data privacy** and the fear of misuse.
- Many respondents feel **uncomfortable** with AI making decisions without human involvement.
- Trust in AI systems for sensitive decisions (like hiring or medical diagnosis) is generally **low**.
- A large portion of participants believe AI may cause **job loss and unemployment**.
- Many agreed that AI could be **misused by students** to cheat or avoid learning.
- Participants recognized AI's role in **enhancing creativity** through new tools and inspiration.
- The majority believe AI currently **empowers individuals** rather than controls them.
- Most respondents think **governments, tech companies, and users** should all be responsible for AI safety.
- Overall, AI is seen more as a "**friend**" than a threat, though caution remains about its future capabilities.

CONCLUSION:

This study explored public perceptions of Artificial Intelligence, examining whether it is seen as a helpful ally or a silent threat. While concerns such as job loss, data privacy, and overreliance on AI were clearly expressed, most participants acknowledged the significant benefits AI offers in daily life, including saving time, increasing efficiency, and enhancing creativity.

The majority of respondents viewed AI as a supportive force that empowers individuals rather than something meant to control them. They also agreed that humans should remain involved in critical decisions and that proper regulation is essential. Despite some unease about AI's rapid advancement and potential to surpass human intelligence, people largely described their overall feelings toward AI as friendly and positive.

Overall, the findings suggest that while the public is aware of the risks, they are more inclined to embrace AI as a powerful tool that, with the right guidance and safeguards, can enhance human potential rather than threaten it.

REFERENCES

Pichai, S. (2018). Google I/O 2018 Keynote.

Mitchell, M. (2019). Artificial intelligence: A guide for thinking humans.

Pew Research Center. (2025, April 3).

How the US public and AI experts view Artificial Intelligence

APPENDIX

How often do you use AI technologies (★
eg: chatgpt , smart devices)?



☐ Daily

☐ Weekly

☐ Rarely

☐ Never

Which of the following do you consider a ★
benefit of AI?

☐ Save time and effort

☐ Improves accuracy and efficiency

☐ Automates repetitive tasks

Which of these are your biggest concerns of AI? *

- ☐ Job loss due to automation
- ☐ Data privacy
- ☐ Lack of human control
- ☐ Deep fakes and misinformation

How much do you trust AI systems in sensitive decisions(eg: hiring , grading , medical diagnosis) ? *

- ☐ Fully Trusted
- ☐ Mostly
- ☐ Slightly
- ☐ Not at all

Would you feel uncomfortable if AI systems made decisions without human control? *

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No



How do you perceive AI's influences on human activity? *

- ☐ AI enhance creativity by providing new tools and inspirations
- ☐ AI stifles creativity by making us overly reliant on technology

In your opinion, is AI more likely to empower individuals or control them? *

- ☐ Empower individuals by providing them with new capabilities
- ☐ Control individuals through surveillance and manipulation

Which of the following best reflects your view of AI's impact on society? *

- ☐ Primarily beneficial , improving our lives
- ☐ Primarily harmful , posing significant risk

Do you think AI can also become more powerful than humans in future? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

Is AI making people lazy in thinking and problem solving? *

☐ Strongly disagree

☐ Disagree

☐ Agree

☐ Strongly agree

Do you think students may misuse AI tools for cheating and avoiding learning? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

Would you feel uncomfortable if AI systems made decisions without human control? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

Are you concerned that AI collects too much personal data? *

☐ Yes

☐ No

Who should be responsible for making sure AI is used safely? *

☐ Government

☐ Tech Companies

☐ User

☐ All of above

Which statement comes closer to your opinion on AI's role in future of your work? *

- ☐ AI will create more job opportunities than it eliminates
- ☐ AI will lead to significant job displacement and unemployment

Are you worried that AI can be use to track or monitor people without their consent? *

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

Is AI slowly taking over human decisions making? *

- ☐ Strongly disagree
- ☐ Disagree
- ☐ Agree
- ☐ Strongly agree



How would you describe your overall feelings toward AI? *

☐ Friend

☐ Foe

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